



PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

WHAT ADVICE WOULD YOU GIVE TO YOUR YOUNGER SELF?

I could have completed further education. I finished my BA and got married

YOUR MANTRA FOR NAVIGATING CHALLENGES?

My school's motto, "Never Give In", and keep trying till the very end as something will come out

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JYOTSNA SURI HAS been associated with The Lalit Suri Hospitality Group since its inception, and she became the group's Joint Managing Director in the late '80s. In 2006, she took on the mantle of Chairperson and Managing Director, following the demise of her husband Lalit Suri. Since then, she has been the group's driving force.

She rebranded the hotel chain, "The LaLiT", as a tribute to the Founder Chairman. Earlier, the hotel chain used to run under a franchise contract with brands such as InterContinental, Holiday Inn, and Hilton.

Under her stewardship, The Lalit Suri Hospitality Group has become one of the leading privately owned domestic hotel brands in India, engaged in operating and managing hotels, palaces, and resorts, with a focus

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BY RICHA SHARMA



JYOTSNA SURI

72, CMD, The Lalit Suri Hospitality Group

both on the luxury and mid-segment properties.

The hospitality sector has seen some tough times during Covid-19, says Suri, adding that her focus is on making her balance sheet healthy. With some of those issues resolved, the group is looking to set up two new properties, in Ahmedabad and Chitrakoot.

"I am looking at consolidation and not really getting into any new development except these two. We are expanding our portfolio by virtue of a management contract with a focus on mid-segment hotels in Tier II cities under our brand the Lalit Traveller," she tells *BT*. For stewarding her business out of the doldrums of Covid-19, Suri makes a comeback in the *BT* MPW list this year after a five-year hiatus. **BT**

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